



Wildfire Go-Bag and Evacuation Checklist

A go-bag is what you grab to be out the door in two minutes. Pack it once, keep it where you can reach it in the dark, and check it twice a year. In a fast-moving fire there is no time to gather anything, so the gathering happens now.

LEAVE EARLY. DO NOT WAIT FOR A CHECKLIST

If officials issue a warning or an order for your zone, or you simply feel at risk, go. A packed bag is a backup to leaving early, never a reason to stay a few minutes longer. Nothing on this page is worth more than the time it takes to get out.

THE 6 P'S: IF YOU HAVE TO LEAVE RIGHT NOW

- ☐ **People and pets**, including anyone who needs help getting out
- ☐ **Papers**: phone numbers, IDs, insurance, and other important documents
- ☐ **Prescriptions**: medications, vitamins, and eyeglasses
- ☐ **Pictures** and irreplaceable keepsakes
- ☐ **Personal computer**, hard drive, and any backup disks or drives
- ☐ **Plastic and cash**: credit and debit cards, and cash

THE BAG ITSELF: PACKED AHEAD OF TIME

- ☐ Three days of non-perishable food, and three gallons of water per person
- ☐ A paper map with at least two ways out of the area marked. Cell service and navigation apps both fail up here.
- ☐ Prescriptions and any medications you take regularly
- ☐ A change of clothes, plus spare eyeglasses or contact lenses
- ☐ Spare car keys, credit cards, and cash in small bills
- ☐ First aid kit and sanitation supplies
- ☐ Flashlight and a battery-powered radio, with spare batteries
- ☐ N95 masks for smoke
- ☐ Phone and laptop chargers, and a charged battery pack
- ☐ Copies of important documents: birth certificates, passports, insurance, deed or lease
- ☐ Pet food, water, and a carrier or leash for every animal
- ☐ **By the bed**: sturdy shoes and a flashlight, ready for an evacuation that starts at 2 a.m.

BEFORE FIRE SEASON, NOT DURING IT

- ☐ Sign up for **CruzAware** so county evacuation alerts reach your phone: cruzaware.org
- ☐ Look up your evacuation zone at protect.genasys.com and learn the zone name, not just the street
- ☐ Keep at least half a tank of gas in the car through fire season
- ☐ Park facing out
- ☐ Agree on a meeting place and an out-of-area contact, and make sure everyone in the house knows both

WRITE IT DOWN NOW, WHILE IT IS EASY

Fill this in and keep the page with the bag. In an evacuation nobody remembers a zone name or a policy number.

My evacuation zone

Meeting place

Out-of-area contact and number

Insurance company and policy number

Vet or boarding, for the animals

Second way out of my road

WHAT THE THREE LEVELS MEAN

The county uses three tiers, and the difference matters when you are deciding whether to move.

- Evacuation Watch** A possible threat to life and property. Get ready, and go now if you need extra time, have animals to load, or would rather not do this in the dark.
- Evacuation Warning** A potential threat. This is the point to leave. Waiting for an order is how people end up driving out through smoke on a one-lane road.
- Evacuation Order** An immediate threat. The area is legally closed and you should already be gone.

Zones are named, not described by street, which is why looking yours up in advance matters. Lifted and All Clear are separate announcements; a lifted order does not always mean services are back.

WHERE THE OFFICIAL WORD COMES FROM

Evacuation warnings and orders for Boulder Creek come from the **Santa Cruz County Sheriff's Office** and **CAL FIRE**, delivered through **CruzAware** (cruzaware.org) and the evacuation-zone map at protect.genasys.com. This sheet is preparation guidance. It is not an evacuation order, and it cannot tell you that a route or an area is safe. For any fire or emergency, call 911.

Packing list follows CAL FIRE's Ready for Wildfire emergency supply kit guidance (readyforwildfire.org) and the 6 P's evacuation list published by fire agencies including the Los Angeles Fire Department and the American Red Cross. Zone and alert links checked July 2026.